

Business Problem Statement

Project: MoFlow: Smart Recurring Bill Payments Platform

Role: Business Analyst

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Introduction

This document defines the business problem that MoFlow seeks to address and establishes the rationale for developing a recurring bill payment platform. It provides an overview of the current payment landscape, identifies the key challenges experienced by users and businesses, examines the underlying causes of these challenges, and outlines the opportunity for a digital solution.

The purpose of this document is to ensure that all stakeholders share a common understanding of the problem before moving into requirements elicitation, solution design, and product development.

Business Context

The adoption of mobile money services has transformed the way individuals and businesses conduct financial transactions. Users increasingly rely on digital payment platforms to pay utility bills, rent, internet subscriptions, school fees, insurance premiums, loan repayments, and other recurring financial obligations.

Although mobile money has simplified digital payments, recurring obligations are still largely managed through manual processes. Users must remember payment due dates, initiate transactions individually, monitor multiple payment schedules, and maintain their own reminders using calendars, notes, or messaging applications.

As the number of recurring financial commitments increases, managing these obligations becomes more time-consuming, error-prone, and difficult to track.

Current Situation (AS-IS)

The current recurring payment experience presents several operational and user experience challenges.

Current Process

Users are required to:

- Remember payment due dates.
- Manually initiate every recurring payment.
- Monitor multiple payment schedules across different service providers.
- Track completed payments independently.
- Resolve failed or missed payments without centralized support.

While existing payment platforms enable users to transfer money and pay bills, they typically provide limited capabilities for managing recurring financial obligations through automation, reminders, or centralized payment scheduling.

Problem Statement

Individuals and small businesses lack an efficient and centralized solution for managing recurring financial obligations through mobile money.

As a result, users frequently rely on memory or external reminder tools to manage recurring payments. This manual approach increases the likelihood of missed due dates, late payment penalties, interrupted services, duplicate payments, and unnecessary administrative effort.

The absence of an integrated recurring payment management experience negatively affects both customers and service providers by reducing payment reliability, increasing operational inefficiencies, and impacting overall customer satisfaction.

Root Cause Analysis

The following table identifies the primary business problems and their underlying causes.

Business Problem	Root Cause
Missed recurring payments	Users depend on memory or external reminders.
Late payment penalties	No automated payment scheduling.
Service interruptions	Payments are not completed before due dates.
High administrative effort	Users manually repeat the same payment process.
Poor payment visibility	No centralized dashboard for recurring obligations.

Difficulty managing multiple payments	Financial commitments are spread across different providers and payment dates.
Customer support enquiries	Users require assistance after missed or failed payments.
Low engagement with payment platforms	Existing payment experience focuses on one-time transactions rather than long-term financial management.

Business Impact

The identified challenges create measurable impacts across multiple stakeholder groups.

Impact on Individual Users

- Increased likelihood of missed payment deadlines.
- Exposure to late payment penalties and additional charges.
- Service interruptions resulting from unpaid bills.
- Greater financial stress caused by manually managing recurring obligations.
- Reduced visibility into future payment commitments.
- Increased time spent performing repetitive payment tasks.

Impact on Small Businesses

- Delayed payments to suppliers and service providers.
- Reduced operational efficiency due to manual payment administration.
- Difficulty forecasting recurring operational expenses.
- Increased risk of missed supplier obligations affecting business continuity.

Impact on Service Providers

- Higher payment default rates.
- Increased customer support requests related to missed or failed payments.
- Delayed revenue collection.
- Lower customer satisfaction.
- Additional operational costs associated with payment reminders and collections.

Impact on the Business

From a product and business perspective, the absence of a recurring payment management solution represents a missed opportunity to:

- Increase recurring transaction volumes.
- Improve customer retention.

- Strengthen user engagement.
- Differentiate the digital payment experience.
- Generate additional revenue through higher platform usage.

Assumptions

The following assumptions have been made for this Business Analysis case study:

- Users possess an active mobile money account.
- Users regularly make recurring financial payments.
- Users have access to smartphones and internet connectivity.
- Payment service providers expose secure payment APIs that support transaction processing.
- Users value convenience, automation, and payment transparency.
- Regulatory and compliance requirements permit recurring digital payment services.

These assumptions are intended solely for this portfolio case study and do not represent the operational environment of any specific organization.

Opportunity Statement

The identified challenges present an opportunity to improve the recurring payment experience through a centralized digital platform that enables users to automate recurring transactions while maintaining full visibility and control over their payment schedules.

By providing payment scheduling, automated reminders, transaction history, and recurring payment management capabilities, MoFlow can improve payment reliability, reduce administrative effort, enhance customer satisfaction, and encourage greater adoption of digital payment services.

The proposed solution also creates opportunities for service providers and payment platforms to increase recurring transaction volumes, improve customer retention, and reduce payment-related operational costs.

Success Criteria

The business problem will be considered successfully addressed when the solution demonstrates measurable improvements in both user experience and business performance.

Success will be evaluated using the following criteria:

- Reduction in missed recurring payments.
- Reduction in late payment penalties experienced by users.
- Increased adoption of recurring payment scheduling.
- Improvement in successful payment completion rates.

- Reduction in payment-related customer support requests.
- Increased customer satisfaction (CSAT).
- Improved customer retention and engagement.
- Growth in recurring transaction volumes.
- Increased visibility into users' recurring financial commitments.

Conclusion

The current recurring payment experience relies heavily on manual user intervention, creating inefficiencies that affect individuals, businesses, and service providers alike. As recurring financial obligations continue to increase, the limitations of manual payment management become more pronounced, leading to missed payments, financial penalties, operational inefficiencies, and reduced customer satisfaction.

MoFlow presents an opportunity to address these challenges by providing a secure, centralized, and user-friendly platform for managing recurring mobile money payments. By aligning user needs with business objectives, the proposed solution aims to improve payment reliability, strengthen customer engagement, and support sustainable business growth.

This Business Problem Statement establishes the foundation for subsequent Business Analysis activities, including stakeholder analysis, requirements elicitation, process modelling, solution design, user story development, and Agile product planning.